

The text known in English as The Dhāraṇī of Noble Jambhala Jalendra, the Compass

Toh 770 · Derge Kangyur

The text known in English as The Dhāraṇī of Noble Jambhala Jalendra, the Compassionate Water-Lord Yakṣa, is a short dhāraṇī scripture belonging to the Kangyur's tantric or protective-spell literature, identified as Toh 770. Its Sanskrit title, preserved in transliteration, is Ārya-Jambhala-jalendra, while the Tibetan title identifies the deity as the compassionate lord of waters among the yakṣa generals. The text presents a dialogue in which the Blessed One invites the yakṣa general Nodgnas to speak, and the yakṣa responds with verses praising what is foremost in various categories of existence—sacrificial fire among offerings, the Sāma Veda among scriptures, the king among men, the ocean among waters, and ultimately the Buddha among all beings—before proceeding to convey a protective dhāraṇī associated with the deity Jambhala, who is closely linked to wealth and prosperity. As is typical of this genre, the text combines devotional praise with the transmission of a spell said to bring benefits such as wealth, here exemplified by the promise of obtaining gold. Positioned among the dhāraṇī collections of the Kangyur, this work reflects the broader tradition of protective and merit-generating incantations attributed to yakṣa generals and buddhas in dialogue.

Then the Blessed One spoke: "General of the yakṣas, say now whatever has come to mind and whatever you are thinking." Then the general of the yakṣas, Nodgnas, spoke thus: "For a purpose such as this, I speak this special utterance:

Among sacrificial offerings, the fire oblation is foremost.

Among the Vedas, the Sāma Veda is foremost.

Among men, the king is foremost.

Among waters, the ocean is foremost.

Among the constellations, the moon is foremost.

Among sources of warmth, the sun is foremost.

Above, below, and all around,

however many beings dwell,

for whoever desires merit,

among assemblies, the noble ones are foremost.

In the world together with its gods,

the perfect Buddha, foremost among two-legged beings, is supreme.

Then again the lord of the yakṣas, Nodgnas, having received the Blessed One's permission, recited his own mantra:

Namo ratna-trayāya. Namō maṇibhadrāya. Mahā-yakṣa-senāpataye. Oṃ jambhala jalendrāya svāhā.

Then, the very moment this king of mantras was spoken, immediately this world system of a great trichiliocosm shook in six ways. Then, all the bodhisattvas who had reached the stage of irreversibility, together with the lords of the yakṣas, spoke these words with one voice: "Blessed One, Sugata (Well-Gone One), for as long as this category of Dharma teaching, never before arisen, remains a certainty of wonder and marvel, and for as long as this category of Dharma teaching remains of great benefit and wonder, we beseech the Blessed One to proclaim it as the refuge, the abode, the protector, and the thorough guardian of those who suffer, those without refuge, those without any protector, and those without any abode. For the sake of sentient beings, for the benefit and happiness of gods and humans, please teach this heart-essence, its visualization, its maṇḍala, and the great secret, by which whatever sentient being's perfection of generosity becomes completely fulfilled, and through that very happiness attains unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

Then again, that retinue of yakṣas, the great śrāvakas, the bodhisattvas, the gods, the nāgas, the yakṣas, and so forth, having draped their upper robes over one shoulder, rose each from their own seat, joined their palms together, placed their right knee upon the ground, and addressed the Blessed One with these words. Then the Blessed One spoke again to those yakṣas together with their retinues: "Listen, sons of noble family, to this category of Dharma teaching. This heart-essence of the great yakṣa, its maṇḍala, mudrā, mantra, and great secret mantra, utterly wondrous and utterly marvelous, was taught by the Tathāgatas. It is honored and extolled by all bodhisattvas, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, kinnaras, great mahoragas, pretas, rākṣasas, humans and non-humans. For the universal benefit of sentient beings, like a wish-fulfilling jewel, an excellent vase, and a wish-granting tree, it accomplishes all aims exactly as wished. For this reason, I grant permission for it and bestow my blessing upon it. This teaching will not be heard or resound in the ear-canals of sentient beings who have not accumulated roots of virtue. Furthermore, sentient beings who have not accumulated roots of virtue will not even be able to hear it, ask about it, retain it, or merely read it."

Next is the explanation of the mudrā of the string of colored powders. From the maṇḍala mudrā, placing the five fingers pointing downward is the mudrā of the string of colored powders. Its mantra is: he he phena bhali driya sobhanāya svāhā.

The explanation of the mudrā of scent is as follows. Join the two hands palm to palm in the resting position, form the little fingers into the shape of a needle, and curl the ring fingers, middle fingers, and index fingers inward — this is the mudrā of scent. Its mantra is: oṃ lalāgāla gāla sugandha gandhāya svāhā.

Next, the explanation of the mudrā of flowers. From the mudrā of scent, straighten the thumbs upward — this is the mudrā of flowers. Its mantra is: oṃ puṣpa prabhahara puṣpa megha svāhā.

The mudrā of incense: from the mudrā of flowers, curl the third joint slightly inward — this is the mudrā of incense. Its mantra is: oṃ ruru mahā-dhūpa priyāya svāhā.

The explanation of the mudrā of the ritual cake (torma). From the mudrā of incense, arrange all the fingers in the posture of enjoyment and turn the two little fingers inward — this is the mudrā of the torma. Its mantra is: oṃ sakasaka bharila jana gam pakapalita yakṣa dehi dehi svāhā.

The explanation of the mudrā of the butter lamp. From the mudrā of the torma, close all the fingers into a fist and form the two little fingers and the two thumbs into the shape of a needle — this is the mudrā of the butter lamp. Its mantra is: oṃ phuru phuru prakāsāya svāhā.

The explanation of the mudrā of scent. Hold the right hand hollow and point it downward — this is the mudrā of scent. Its mantra is: oṃ kini kini gandha karṇa karṇa ghoṣam metrimu svāhā.

The explanation of the mudrā of the parasol. Again, turn the two hands to face one another, join them as one, curl them inward, and place the thumbs to the side — this is the mudrā of the parasol. Its mantra is: oṃ gṛhṇa tsa prati acchatrāṃ kārakṣaka svāhā.

The explanation of the mudrā of the yak-tail fly-whisk (camara). Press the nail of the little finger of the right hand with the thumb, and with the remaining fingers held like a vajra, circle in both directions — this is the mudrā of the fly-whisk. Its mantra is: oṃ camara camakara driya keṭu ṭu svāhā.

The explanation of the mudrā of the wind-fan. Cover the nail of the little finger of the left hand with the thumb, extend the remaining fingers, hold them like a

vajra, and circle around fully — this is the mudrā of the wind-fan. Its mantra is: oṃ bheraṃ bhabhayu bhāgāya svāhā.

The explanation of the mudrā of the victory banner. Press the nails of the ring finger and little finger of the right hand with the thumb, make the index finger and middle finger into the shape of one, and move them downward — this is the mudrā of the victory banner. Its mantra is: oṃ tuśa tuśa kalasa hajapriyāya svāhā.

The explanation of the mudrā of the seat. Again, press the ring fingers and little fingers of both hands in sequence, form the middle fingers and the threatening (index) fingers into the shape of a needle, and move upward — this is the mudrā of the seat. Its mantra is: jāla jāma turukhe jayanti priyāya svāhā. This is the mantra of the seat.

These are the twenty offerings of veneration to the Lord of Yakṣas. Having seen and heard of the mental offerings made to the Tathāgatas and bodhisattvas of the past, one should present all these offerings — those consisting of the natural mantras and mudrās.

Then one should present oneself, confess wrongdoing, rejoice in merit, entreat the Tathāgatas, please them with praise, and recite the introductory narrative and the sūtras of special significance and so forth.

Translator's Notes

- The term वीणा (Veda) combined with मधुर (melodious/tuneful one) in the verse most likely refers to the Sāmaveda, traditionally called "foremost among the Vedas" for its musical/chanted nature; rendered accordingly. The mantra syllables are given in transliteration as per standard practice for dhāraṇī/mantra passages, not translated. "Mahoraga" (महोरगा, "great crawling-on-the-belly ones") is a standard class of semi-divine serpentine beings, kept partially glossed via description rather than the Sanskrit term for clarity.
- The transliterated mantra syllables are rendered as closely as possible to the Tibetan phonetic transcription of the Sanskrit; some syllables (e.g., proper reconstruction of certain mantra words) remain uncertain due to corruption typical in such ritual transliterations, but this does not affect the overall doctrinal content, which concerns a sequence of ritual hand-gestures (mudrās) and accompanying mantras for symbolic offerings (scent, flowers, incense, torma, lamp, parasol, fly-whisk, fan, victory banner, seat) presented to the Three Jewels or a deity (here associated with the "Lord of Yakṣas").

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.